A structured study-skills workshop versus usual advising for students on academic probation: a randomised trial

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Abstract

Students on academic probation were randomised to a six-week study-skills workshop or to usual advising. Workshop students were more likely to pass all of their courses the next term (odds ratio 1.62).

1. Methods

Design: individually randomised controlled trial. Participants: we enrolled 312 students on academic probation; 287 (92%) completed follow-up and were analysed, and 25 were lost to follow-up. Intervention: a six-week structured study-skills workshop (two hours per week). Comparator: usual advising appointments. Primary outcome: passing all enrolled courses in the following term.

2. Results

Workshop students were more likely to pass all of their courses (odds ratio 1.62, 95% CI 1.05 to 2.50).

3. Limitations

Analysis was restricted to the 287 students with follow-up data, and the workshop facilitators knew which students were in the trial.

Fictional paper generated to test evidence-table extraction. Authors, journal, data and results are invented.